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A guide to who we are,  
what we do, and how we work

*“Every investigation begins with a question. Every question, with the  
courage to ask it.”*

## Preface

This document was born out of a real need: to organize and record what **Misters** represents — not just as a project, but as a life decision spanning years of history, fresh starts, and evolution. **The origin** Misters did not begin as a security research group. On

November 30, 2020, it was born as a WhatsApp initiative with a simpler goal: to protect text-based RPG communities from attacks and harassment by malicious users. It was a small group, about ten people, united by a symbol: the red flower.

*“Behind every petal, a poison you never saw coming.”*

Over time, the group faced its own internal challenges. Gradual discouragement led to the dissolution of that first format. But the idea didn’t die — it matured. **Four years of**

**rebuilding** What you’re reading now isn’t an improved version of what existed before — it’s something fundamentally different, built from scratch over nearly four years. Four years organizing methodologies, testing structures, discarding what didn’t work, and refining what remained. Four years carrying the emotional weight of building something many people didn’t understand. The result is this: Misters re-emerged with a clear identity as a group of **independent researchers**, dedicated to confronting serious crimes that hide behind the anonymity of the internet. **Acknowledgments** To every

member of Misters — for the commitment, the hours dedicated, and the daily certainty that this work matters. And to everyone who, at some point in this long history, believed something like this could be built. **What you’ll find in this document** In the following

pages, you’ll learn about Misters’ mission, its areas of operation, the methodology used in research and investigations, and how the group is organized internally. More than a technical document, this is a record of identity — of who we are, what we believe, and why we continue.

— MrWest  
Founder of Misters

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# 1 What is Misters?

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*“Behind every petal, a poison you never saw coming.”*

**Misters** is an independent, volunteer group of **security researchers**, dedicated to combating serious crimes that hide behind the anonymity of the internet. Born in 2020 as a simple initiative to protect online communities, Misters went through a long maturation process before re-emerging with a broader purpose, rigorous methodology, and a consolidated identity — united by the symbol that has always defined it: the red flower.

The group’s work is technical, organized, and methodology-driven, focused on **gathering evidence**, **tracking threat actors**, and **supporting the accountability** of criminals who use the digital environment as a shield.

This work is not carried out by authorities or a company — it is conducted by researchers who believe technical knowledge can and should be put to the service of causes that protect lives. There are no profit motives, financial rewards, or formal institutional ties: what drives Misters is a commitment to the safety of those who have no voice or means to protect themselves.

## 1.1 Who We Are

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Misters is made up of volunteer researchers with backgrounds and experience in fields such as information security, OSINT (Open Source Intelligence), and digital investigation. The group operates pseudonymously, as a personal protection measure given the inherent risks of this type of work — since direct contact and public exposure of those involved could compromise both ongoing investigations and the safety of those conducting them.

### On Identities and Anonymity

Protecting researchers’ identities is not an obstacle to the transparency of the work carried out, but rather a necessary safeguard given the sensitive nature of the cases investigated. The evidence and methodologies used are rigorously documented, so that their validity does not depend on the personal exposure of those who produced them.

Misters recognizes that confronting this type of criminality demands more than good intentions: it demands technique, discipline, and responsibility with every piece of information handled. That is why the group remains firm in its mission — using technical

knowledge as a tool for protection, not exposure or revenge.

## 1.2 Areas of Operation

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Misters focuses its efforts on four main fronts, chosen because they represent some of the most serious and urgent forms of violence carried out or coordinated through the internet:

### Research and Investigation Focus Areas

- **School massacres:** Monitoring discourse, forums, and communities where concrete threats against educational institutions are planned or shared — aiming to identify and report risks before they turn into tragedies.
- **Animal abuse:** Identifying individuals and networks that produce, share, or profit from animal cruelty content on digital platforms, helping these cases reach the relevant authorities.
- **Pedophilia and child exploitation:** Tracking profiles, groups, and digital structures used for the exploitation and abuse of children, forwarding collected evidence to the legal channels responsible for investigation and accountability.
- **Hate crimes:** Mapping discourse that incites violence, coordinates attacks, and funds extremist groups that use the internet to spread and organize violence directed at vulnerable groups.

Each case is handled with methodological rigor, structured documentation, and a commitment to the integrity of the evidence collected — preserving its validity for use by authorities, platforms, or other channels responsible for holding those involved accountable.

## 1.3 How Misters Is Organized

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Misters operates with a clear hierarchical structure, divided into three pillars — **Central**, **Lineage**, and **Connection** — each with its own functions, roles, and autonomy. Within each pillar, investigative work is carried out collaboratively, with responsibilities distributed according to each researcher's specialty and coordinated by a person designated per case.

### Individual Specialties

Each Misters researcher has an area of greater technical expertise — recognized by the group and built through practice. There is no rigid assignment of roles by task; rather, each person naturally leads and contributes more deeply in the stages closest to their expertise, whether in OSINT and tracking, technical infrastructure analysis, forensic writing and documentation, or coordination with external channels and authorities.

This organic distribution ensures the group operates efficiently — the right knowledge shows up at the right time.

### Case Coordinator

For each open investigation, one researcher takes on the role of **case coordinator**. This role does not grant hierarchical authority over the others — it exists to ensure operational cohesion within that specific investigation. The coordinator is responsible for:

- Keeping the case's centralized record up to date;
- Ensuring no phase is skipped or incompletely documented;
- Serving as the internal point of reference for questions and decisions about that investigation;
- Leading the final referral to the relevant authorities or channels.

The coordinator role is **rotating** — any researcher can take it on, and the choice is made by consensus for each new case, respecting the hierarchical structure of the pillar the case belongs to.

### Investigation Phases

Every investigation conducted by Misters follows a sequential flow of phases. No stage may be skipped or jumped ahead of without group consensus:

- **Phase 1 — Triage:** initial assessment of the case. The group checks whether there is sufficient evidence, whether the case fits within Misters'



areas of operation, and whether there is operational capacity to investigate it at the time.

- **Phase 2 — Collection:** gathering of information, data, and evidence through OSINT techniques and digital tracking. Everything collected is preserved with integrity from the very first moment.
- **Phase 3 — Analysis:** correlating the collected data, identifying actors, behavioral patterns, and the structures involved. This is the phase of greatest technical depth.
- **Phase 4 — Documentation:** formal structuring of the dossier or investigative report, recording all evidence, methodologies used, and conclusions reached.
- **Phase 5 — Referral:** sending the produced material to the relevant authorities, platforms, or other channels responsible for holding those involved accountable.

### Non-Negotiable Principles

Regardless of the case, phase, or hierarchical pillar involved, certain principles govern every Misters operation:

- **Mandatory documentation:** no investigative action is valid without structured records. What is not documented does not exist.
- **Compartmentalization:** sensitive information about a case is restricted to researchers actively involved in it.
- **No unauthorized exposure:** evidence and identities of those under investigation are not made public without prior formal referral.
- **Consensus before action:** decisions that affect the direction of an investigation are made collectively, never unilaterally.

## 2 Misters' Values

*"Values are not rules. They are the reason rules make sense."*

Misters' values were not defined in a meeting — they were distilled over years of practice, mistakes, fresh starts, and learning. They exist because a technical group without values is just a group of people with tools. And tools without purpose are dangerous.

These nine values are the pillars that support everything Misters does. Violating them is not just a conduct failure — it is a contradiction of the very reason the group exists.

### The 9 Core Values

1. **Respect** — Respect is the value that makes all the others possible. Without it, there is no collaboration, no trust, and no mission. A Misters researcher treats every member, every victim, and every piece of information with the seriousness they deserve — regardless of who they are or what they represent.
2. **Inclusion** — The group is stronger when every voice is heard. Diversity of perspectives, experiences, and specialties is not an obstacle — it is what makes investigations more thorough and decisions more solid. No one is disposable within Misters.
3. **Teamwork** — Security research is rarely a solitary effort. Working in sync with people of different technical profiles and ways of thinking requires humility, communication, and a willingness to yield when necessary. The collective outcome always outweighs individual effort.
4. **Help and Support** — Misters' reason for existing is to protect those who have no means to protect themselves. This value doesn't apply only to the victims being investigated — it also applies to the group's own members. Supporting one another is part of the operation, not an extra.
5. **Loyalty** — Loyalty to the mission, the group, and the values — in that order. Within Misters, loyalty does not mean blind agreement: it means commitment to the purpose even when it's difficult, and honesty when something is wrong. The lack of loyalty is what breaks groups apart — and Misters has already learned that the hard way.
6. **Courage** — Investigating serious crimes, dealing with disturbing content, and confronting hostile actors requires real courage. Not the absence of fear — but the ability to act even in its presence. Misters doesn't ask its researchers to be invulnerable. It asks that they not give up when it matters.

7. **Competence and Conduct** — Being a Misters researcher is a distinction that must be upheld by the quality of one's work and conduct. Threats, unnecessary exposure, and impulsive behavior contradict everything the group represents. A Mister's conduct speaks before any words do.
8. **Forgiveness** — Misters' work exposes its researchers to heavy situations — internal conflicts, mistakes, frustrations, and the emotional weight of dealing with the worst of the internet. Forgiveness is not weakness: it is what keeps the buildup of resentment from destroying the group from within. Lessons are learned from mistakes. Their weight is not carried forever.
9. **Fun** — A group that never celebrates its successes loses the drive to face the next challenges. Recognizing achievements, marking victories — however small — and keeping a sense of purpose alive is just as important as any technical protocol. Misters takes the work seriously. It doesn't need to be grim to do so.

#### Values and Rules — The Difference

Values define **who Misters is**. Rules define **what Misters does and how**. A researcher who follows the rules but ignores the values fulfills the form without the substance. A researcher who embodies the values rarely needs to be reminded of the rules — because they act from them. Both are necessary. But values come first.

## 3 Misters' Hierarchy

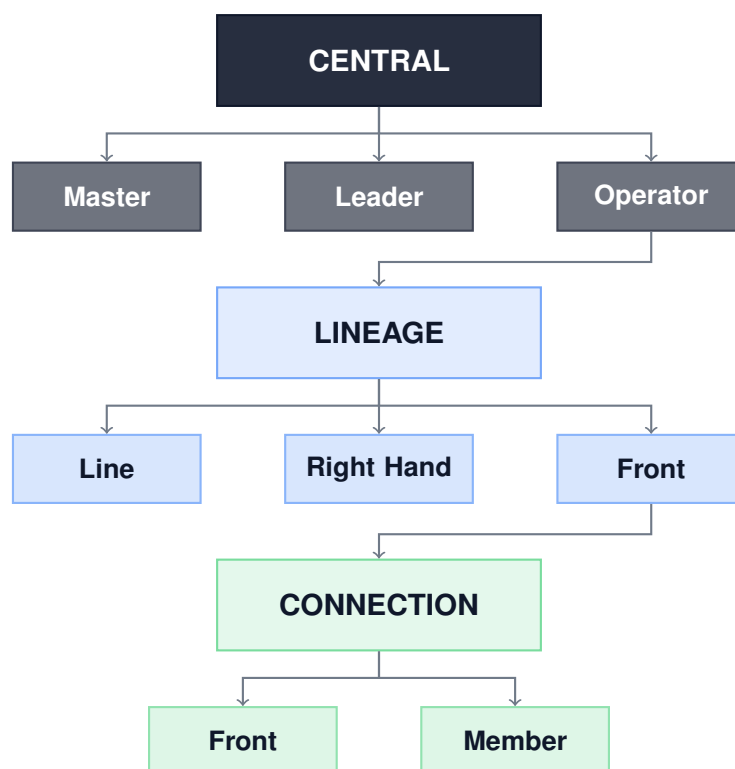
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*"Structure is not control — it's what ensures the right work reaches the right person."*

Misters operates with a clear hierarchical structure, built to balance operational autonomy with organizational accountability. The organization is divided into three sequential pillars: **Central**, **Lineage**, and **Connection**. Each pillar has its own functions, roles, and autonomy — but all answer to the same Misters values and protocols.

### 3.1 Hierarchy Map

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## 3.2 Central

### Central — Misters' Governing Core

Central is the top of Misters' hierarchy. Central members hold ultimate authority over the organization, with the ability to alter protocols, manage researchers, create guidelines, and implement structural decisions.

Central is composed of three roles:

- **Master:** a unique, non-transferable position — the permanent guardian of the organization's original mission and values.
- **Leader:** Misters' operational administrator. Coordinates Central, mediates decisions, represents the organization internally, and ensures guidelines are followed across all pillars. Any high-impact initiative must pass through the Leader before being implemented. In the Master's absence, the Leader is the group's primary point of reference. A vote is held every two months to appoint a new Leader.
- **Operators:** highly trusted researchers with direct authority over one Lineage each. The number of active Lineages in Misters is determined by the number of available Operators — each Operator manages exactly one Lineage. They can make operational decisions within their Lineage, but cannot promote structural changes.

#### Lineage Limit

The number of active Lineages in Misters is directly proportional to the number of Operators in Central. If there are 3 Operators, there are 3 active Lineages. If there are 5 Operators, there are 5 Lineages. No Lineage can exist without an Operator responsible for it.

## 3.3 Lineage

### Lineage — Focus-Based Groups

Lineages are groups with specific areas of focus within Misters. Each Lineage has the autonomy to define its own internal rules, recruitment methods, member management practices, and identity — including its own pseudonym that distinguishes it within the organization.

Each Lineage is composed of three internal roles:

- **Line:** the highest role within the Lineage — held by the Central Operator who manages it. The Line is the direct bridge between the Lineage and Central, ensuring organizational guidelines are applied within the group.
- **Right Hand:** the Line's trusted lieutenant. Acts as the operational right hand within the Lineage — takes on the Line's responsibilities in their absence and assists in managing members and affiliated Connections.
- **Front:** a Lineage member with direct responsibility over a Connection. The Front is simultaneously a Lineage member and the leader of the Connection they represent — serving as the bridge between the two pillars.

#### Lineage Autonomy

Each Lineage is free to:

- Define its own **pseudonym** that identifies it inside and outside the organization;
- Establish **internal rules** that complement Misters' own — provided they do not contradict the central values and protocols;
- Define its own **recruitment criteria and methods**;
- Create **management alternatives** suited to its members' profile;
- Found and manage **multiple Connections** tied to its focus area.

## 3.4 Connection

### Connection — Small Groups with Specific Purposes

Connections are the smallest operational groups in Misters' structure. Each Connection has a specific purpose and operates semi-autonomously within the scope of the Lineage it belongs to. A single Lineage can have multiple active Connections simultaneously, each with its own focus and identity.

- **Member limit:** each Connection holds a maximum of **20 active members**.
- **Pseudonym:** every Connection can — and should — have its own name that identifies it within the Lineage and Misters.
- **Defined purpose:** each Connection exists around a clear goal, aligned

with the focus of the Lineage that oversees it.

A Connection's roles are:

- **Front:** the Connection's leader — the same researcher who holds the Front role in the Lineage. Responsible for leading the group, applying Misters' values within the Connection's context, and communicating with the Lineage.
- **Member:** an active Connection member. Follows Misters' guidelines, the Lineage's rules, and the specific goals of the Connection they belong to.

### 3.5 Pseudonyms and Identity

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#### Identity Within the Structure

Misters recognizes that each Lineage and each Connection has its own culture, profile, and way of operating. That's why the organization actively encourages each group to build its own identity — expressed mainly through its pseudonym. A pseudonym does not replace membership in Misters — it complements it. A Connection member is simultaneously part of that Connection, that Lineage, and Misters. The three identities coexist.

- **Misters** is the parent organization — present throughout the entire structure.
- The **Lineage** has its own pseudonym and group identity.
- The **Connection** has its own pseudonym and specific purpose.

This layered identity structure allows groups with very different cultures to coexist within the same organization — united by the same values, but free to express who they are.

## 3.6 Leader Election

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### Bimonthly Election Protocol

The Leader role is renewed every **two months** through an internal vote. This cycle ensures Misters' operational leadership is always legitimized by the group — not just by the Master.

#### How the election works:

1. In the week before the two-month period ends, the Master formally opens the election process on internal channels.
2. Any active Central researcher can be nominated as a candidate — by another researcher or themselves.
3. Voting is conducted pseudonymously on internal channels, with a 48-hour deadline.
4. The candidate with the most votes takes on the role of Leader for the following two-month period.
5. In the event of a tie, the Master casts the deciding vote.
6. The previous Leader returns to their role as Operator, unless the Master decides otherwise.

#### Restrictions:

- Only Central researchers can be candidates for the Leader role.
- The Master does not take part in the vote as a candidate — their position is permanent and not subject to election.
- A Leader may be re-elected an unlimited number of times, as long as the group so decides.
- In situations of active crisis, the election may be postponed by the Master until the crisis is resolved.



## 3.7 Hierarchical Progression

### How to Progress in the Hierarchy

Progression within Misters is always earned — never automatically granted or requested. The natural path is:

1. **Joining as a Connection Member:** every new member starts in a Connection, going through the observation period defined in the onboarding rules.
2. **Progression to Front:** members who demonstrate leadership, commitment, and alignment with Misters' values may be invited to take on the Front role in a Connection.
3. **Integration into the Lineage:** Fronts who stand out may be invited to formally join the Lineage, taking on broader responsibilities.
4. **Right Hand:** highly trusted researchers within the Lineage may be invited by the Line to take on the Right Hand role.
5. **Central Operator:** researchers with a solid track record and the full trust of the Master and Leader may be invited to join Central as Operators.
6. **Leader:** appointed by the Master based on trust and organizational management capability.

#### Progression Rules

- No researcher can skip levels — progression is always sequential.
- No researcher can request a promotion — it is always offered, never claimed.
- Progression can be reversed in cases of serious rule violations or loss of trust.
- The Master is the only role that does not follow this progression — they are the origin of the structure, not a product of it.

## 4 Misters' Rules

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*"Discipline is not a restriction on freedom — it's what makes the work legitimate."*

The following rules complement Misters' values with concrete conduct guidelines. They exist because values alone are not enough in high-pressure situations — where exhaustion, conflict, and urgency can distort judgment. The rules are the anchor when values are being tested.

Failing to follow them can compromise investigations, put researchers at risk, and invalidate evidence — consequences that no good intention can undo.

### 4.1 Internal Conduct and Ethics

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#### Internal Conduct — Rules 1 to 22

1. Respect among researchers is the foundation of everything. Technical disagreements are welcome; personal hostility, never.
2. No researcher represents Misters publicly without prior group consensus.
3. It is forbidden to use resources, contacts, or information obtained within Misters for personal purposes.
4. Credit for an investigation belongs to the group — not to the individual who contributed the most.
5. Every decision affecting the direction of a case must be made collectively. Unilateral actions are forbidden.
6. No researcher should act out of revenge, anger, or personal satisfaction — the motivation must always be protecting victims.
7. Using internal information to pressure, blackmail, or manipulate other researchers is forbidden.
8. Honesty about technical limitations is mandatory. Claiming skills one doesn't have puts investigations at risk.
9. Conflicts between researchers must be resolved internally, without external exposure.
10. No researcher may start an investigation on their own without informing the group.

11. Presenting personal opinions about those under investigation as if they were established facts is forbidden.
12. Volunteer work does not justify negligence. Commitments made must be honored.
13. Researchers should not compete with each other or measure individual contributions.
14. Mocking or belittling any researcher's contribution, regardless of their experience, is forbidden.
15. No investigation should be conducted with the goal of generating content, notoriety, or public engagement.
16. Researchers' emotional well-being is taken seriously. Heavy cases can be declined without needing justification.
17. Pressuring researchers to take part in cases that affect them emotionally is forbidden.
18. Misters does not tolerate prejudice of any kind in its internal channels.
19. No researcher should act as the group's spokesperson without explicit authorization.
20. Loyalty to the mission comes before loyalty to any specific researcher.
21. Case information must not be used as a bargaining chip or instrument of internal power.
22. No researcher is above the rules — time in the group grants no privileges of conduct.

## 4.2 OpSec and Anonymity

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### OpSec and Anonymity — Rules 23 to 42

1. No researcher should reveal their real identity to others without a free, conscious, and voluntary choice to do so.
2. Attempting to discover the real identity of other researchers by any means is forbidden.
3. All internal communication must occur exclusively through the channels defined by the group, with end-to-end encryption.
4. The pseudonym used within Misters must have no traceable link to the

- researcher's external identities.
5. Accessing internal systems and channels from shared devices or public networks without an active VPN is forbidden.
  6. Screenshots of internal channels are strictly forbidden, except when formally requested for case documentation.
  7. Metadata from files shared internally must be removed before sharing.
  8. Mentioning names, cities, workplaces, or any personal data of researchers in internal channels is forbidden.
  9. The group must not be mentioned on personal social media, public forums, or any external environment.
  10. Passwords and access credentials for the group's systems must never be shared, even between researchers.
  11. Every account used in investigations must be separate from the researcher's personal and professional accounts.
  12. Reusing pseudonyms or usernames already used on other platforms is forbidden.
  13. Investigations must not be discussed outside the group's official channels, nor with trusted people outside the group.
  14. Access to internal panels, repositories, and files must be revoked immediately after a researcher leaves.
  15. Storing investigation data in personal cloud services or ones not approved by the group is forbidden.
  16. Any suspected compromise of identity must be reported to the group immediately.
  17. Researchers must use operating systems and browsers dedicated to Misters activities, separate from personal use.
  18. Carrying out sensitive operations without proper connection anonymization is forbidden.
  19. The group's OpSec is a collective responsibility — individual negligence compromises everyone.
  20. When in doubt about the security of an action, the default is not to perform it until there is consensus.

## 4.3 Evidence Handling

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### Evidence Handling — Rules 43 to 64

1. All collected evidence must be preserved in its original form, without any editing, cropping, or modification.
2. The chain of custody for each piece of evidence must be recorded from the moment of collection through to its referral.
3. Collecting evidence by illegal means is forbidden, regardless of the severity of the crime being investigated.
4. Evidence obtained through hacking or unauthorized access will not be accepted or used.
5. Each piece of evidence must include a record of date, time, source, and collection method.
6. Screenshots used as evidence must be accompanied by hash files for integrity verification.
7. Sharing raw evidence with people outside the group without authorization is forbidden.
8. Evidence containing child abuse material must be handled according to a specific protocol, with access restricted to the minimum necessary.
9. No evidence may be deleted or discarded without group consensus and formal record of the decision.
10. Duplicate evidence must be identified and consolidated — duplication adds no value to the investigation.
11. Using evidence from one case in another without formal review and authorization is forbidden.
12. Evidence storage must take place in an encrypted environment with controlled access.
13. Unverified evidence must be marked as such until its authenticity is confirmed.
14. Publishing, leaking, or hinting at the existence of specific evidence in external channels is forbidden.
15. Evidence analysis must be documented separately from the evidence itself.
16. Graphic evidence must be accessed only by the minimum number of researchers necessary for the investigation.
17. No researcher should keep local copies of evidence beyond what is needed for the task at hand.

18. The legal validity of collected evidence must be considered from the moment of collection — legally unusable evidence must be flagged.
19. Evidence may not be used for entertainment, debate, or unnecessary internal exposure.
20. At the end of a case, all evidence must be archived or destroyed according to the protocol defined by the group.
21. No evidence may be presented to authorities without the case coordinator having reviewed the complete set.
22. Access to sensitive evidence must be logged — who accessed it, when, and for what purpose.

## 4.4 External Communication

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### External Communication — Rules 65 to 82

1. No information about ongoing investigations may be disclosed externally, in any form.
2. Contact with authorities must be made exclusively by the case coordinator or a researcher designated for that purpose.
3. Making direct contact with those under investigation, victims, or witnesses without group consensus is forbidden.
4. Misters does not give interviews, statements, or public comments about its methods or cases.
5. Reports and dossiers sent to authorities must undergo collective review before being sent.
6. Using the Misters name in personal communications or to gain external advantages is forbidden.
7. Evidence must be forwarded through appropriate legal channels — reporting to platforms, specialized police units, public prosecutors, or international bodies as applicable.
8. External communications must not reveal the group's composition, size, or operational methods.
9. Publicly responding to accusations, criticism, or speculation about Misters is forbidden.
10. All formal communication with external entities must be logged internally.

11. The group does not form public partnerships, affiliations, or statements of support for external organizations without consensus.
12. Using external channels to resolve internal Misters conflicts is forbidden.
13. Public statements, when necessary, must be drafted collectively and reviewed before publication.
14. Contact with the press without explicit group deliberation and consensus is forbidden.
15. Researchers must neither confirm nor deny their participation in Misters in external contexts.
16. Referring a case to authorities does not end the group's responsibility for following up on the report.
17. Demanding public recognition for work performed is forbidden — the mission is anonymous by nature.
18. All communication must preserve victims' dignity — sensationalist language is forbidden.

## 4.5 Researcher Onboarding and Departure

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### Onboarding and Departure — Rules 83 to 100

1. Joining Misters happens by invitation from an active researcher or by recruitment through an official form — both subject to Central's approval.
2. Every new researcher starts as a Member of a Connection, going through an observation period before gaining access to any active operation.
3. During the observation period, the new researcher has no access to evidence, dossiers, or ongoing cases.
4. Approving a new researcher requires consensus from Central — the Master, the Leader, and the Operator responsible for the Lineage the candidate will be linked to.
5. No researcher may refer someone they don't fully trust. The Connection's Front is the first one responsible for referrals within their Connection.
6. The researcher who refers a new collaborator is co-responsible for their conduct during the observation period.
7. Revealing the existence of Misters to third parties as a form of informal recruitment is forbidden — recruitment must go through the Lineage or the

- official form.
8. Researchers have the right to leave the group at any time, with no need for justification.
  9. A departure must be reported to the Connection's Front or the Lineage's Line, who passes it on to Central.
  10. Upon leaving, the researcher must have all access to channels, repositories, and internal systems revoked — the Operator responsible for the Lineage is responsible for ensuring this revocation.
  11. After leaving, disclosing any information about the group's investigations, researchers, or methods is forbidden — confidentiality obligations are permanent.
  12. Researchers who violate serious rules can be removed by Central without need for a formal vote.
  13. Removal entails immediate revocation of all access and destruction of shared credentials — carried out by the Lineage's Operator and confirmed by Central.
  14. Attempting to rejoin the group after being removed for rule violations is forbidden.
  15. Researchers inactive for an extended period must inform their Connection's Front of their situation — silent absence may result in deliberate removal by Central.
  16. The group keeps no records traceable to the real identity of former researchers after their departure.
  17. No researcher may accumulate access or privileges beyond what is necessary for the functions they perform within their hierarchical pillar.
  18. Participation in Misters is an active commitment — symbolic presence without real contribution is not accepted at any level of the hierarchy.



## 5 Objectives and Mission

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*“A goal can never be completed in absolute terms. But it is possible — and necessary — to never stop pursuing it.”*

Misters exists because there is a type of violence that thrives in silence — protected by anonymity, by a sense of impunity, and by the absence of anyone with both the will and the ability to act. This chapter defines what the group wants to achieve, why these objectives matter, and how to stay true to them when pressure, fatigue, or distraction try to pull it off course.

### 5.1 Misters’ Role in the Digital Environment

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#### Who We Are in This Landscape

In the digital environment, it’s possible to identify three profiles that coexist in any platform, community, or online space:

- **The vulnerable:** ordinary users who navigate without full awareness of the risks around them. Not out of absolute naivety, but due to lack of access to technical information or simply because they never imagined they could become targets. They are the majority — and the ones most in need of protection.
- **The predators:** malicious actors who exploit the digital environment to commit crimes, sow discord, pursue victims, and operate in the shadows with the conviction that they are untouchable. They rely on anonymity as a shield and on the passivity of others as an ally.
- **The researchers:** those who possess the technical knowledge, methodological discipline, and ethical commitment to act where others cannot or will not. Not out of heroism — but out of responsibility. Misters is made up of these researchers.

Recognizing this landscape isn’t arrogance — it’s clarity of purpose. Misters doesn’t exist to become famous, to gain recognition, or to prove something. It exists because there is a real gap between what happens in the digital environment and what formal structures can reach — and because someone needs to fill that space with rigor and responsibility.

## 5.2 Misters' Objectives

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### What Misters Wants to Achieve

Misters' objectives are not goals with an expiration date — they are permanent directions that guide every decision, every investigation, and every protocol of the group. They are:

1. **Identify and document serious digital crimes** with enough methodological rigor that the evidence produced is usable by the relevant authorities — preserving its integrity from collection through to referral.
2. **Refer cases to the appropriate channels** — platforms, specialized police units, public prosecutors, or international bodies — helping ensure that those involved are held accountable through legal channels.
3. **Protect victims** by ensuring that sensitive information about them is handled with dignity, that their identities are not unnecessarily exposed, and that the group's work does not put them at additional risk.
4. **Continuously develop technical capability** — tools, methodologies, and researchers — so that Misters can respond to crimes that constantly evolve in sophistication and scale.
5. **Be a benchmark of conduct** in the field of independent security research: demonstrate that this work can be done with ethics, discipline, and respect for legal boundaries — without vigilantism, irresponsible exposure, or self-promotion.

## 5.3 What Is Not a Misters Objective

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### Objectives Misters Rejects

Just as important as defining what is pursued is being explicit about what is not. The following are not Misters' objectives — and must never become so:

- **Public recognition.** The effectiveness of the work doesn't depend on visibility. A case resolved in silence holds the same value — or more — than one that makes headlines. The pursuit of recognition distorts priorities and compromises operational security.
- **Directly punishing those under investigation.** Misters produces evidence — it does not carry out sentences. Any action aimed at punishing, exposing,

or shaming those under investigation outside legal channels contradicts the group's mission and exposes it to legal risk.

- **Growth for growth's sake.** Having more members, more Lineages, or more Connections is not an objective in itself. Growth without quality, without proper vetting, and without management capacity is a vector for vulnerability — not strength.
- **Competing with other initiatives.** Misters does not compete with other groups, organizations, or independent researchers who operate ethically. The digital environment has enough problems for everyone — and collaboration, when possible, is preferable to rivalry.

## 5.4 How to Avoid Straying From the Objectives

### Staying the Course

Groups that start with noble purposes often lose their way — not out of bad intent, but through the buildup of small concessions that, individually, seemed reasonable. Misters has already been through this in its own history. That's why this chapter exists: not as a guarantee that drift will never happen, but as an anchor for when temptation appears.

The main vectors of drift and how to confront them:

- **Individual ego.** When a researcher starts acting in their own name — seeking credit, making unilateral decisions, or using the group as a personal platform — the collective objective is compromised. The antidote is a culture of consensus and the clarity that credit belongs to the group, not the individual.
- **Pressure for quick results.** Real urgency exists — but so does artificial urgency. When haste leads to skipping steps, documenting poorly, or referring incomplete evidence, the outcome is worse than not having acted at all. The protocol exists precisely to resist this pressure.
- **The pursuit of visibility.** High-impact cases attract attention. Attention attracts the temptation to disclose, comment, or hint. Every time a researcher gives in to that temptation, they put the investigation, the victims, and the group at risk. Operational silence is not weakness — it's discipline.
- **Accumulated resentment.** Heavy work, difficult cases, and unresolved internal conflicts build resentment. Resentment distorts judgment and motivates actions that wouldn't have been taken in a balanced state of

mind. The value of forgiveness and the care for researchers' emotional well-being exist precisely to keep internal buildup from destroying what was built externally.

- **Complacency.** When everything seems to be working, the tendency is to relax protocols. But it's exactly during periods of apparent stability that vulnerabilities quietly take hold. Reviewing, questioning, and updating processes is a permanent responsibility — not just a reactive one.

#### The Mission in One Sentence

If all the complexity of this document had to be summed up in a single statement, it would be this:

*Misters exists to use technical knowledge as a tool for protection — never for exposure, revenge, or self-promotion.*

Anything that contradicts this sentence contradicts Misters.

## 6 Profile of a Researcher

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*“Being a Misters researcher is not a title. It’s a stance — upheld every day, even when no one is watching.”*

Not every volunteer who joins Misters becomes a researcher. Not because the group is exclusionary — but because the work demands a specific profile that isn’t built from good will or interest in digital security alone. This chapter defines what is expected, what sets someone apart, what it is not, and what genuinely makes someone fit to be part of this initiative.

### 6.1 What Is Expected of a Researcher

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#### Fundamental Expectations

A Misters researcher is expected — not merely encouraged — to embody the following behaviors in any and all activity within the group:

- **Real commitment:** being present isn’t enough. A Misters researcher contributes actively, follows through on what they take on, and communicates when they can’t. Symbolic participation has no place here.
- **Constant adaptation:** the security research landscape changes quickly. Tools evolve, criminal tactics grow more sophisticated, and protocols need revisiting. A Misters researcher doesn’t settle in — they keep learning.
- **Genuine collaboration:** ego has no place in an investigation. Sharing knowledge, accepting corrections, and working in sync with people of different profiles is part of the job, not an extra.
- **Methodological discipline:** following investigation phases, documenting every step, and respecting the group’s protocols are not bureaucracy — they are what makes the work valid and the evidence usable.
- **Consistent ethical conduct:** a researcher’s conduct within the group must be the same as it would be outside it. There is no "internal" and "external" version of a Mister — there is only one.

## 6.2 Technical and Behavioral Profile

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### What a Misters Researcher Brings

Misters does not require a fixed minimum technical level to join — it requires a willingness to learn and honesty about what one already knows. The desired profile combines two complementary dimensions:

- **Technical dimension:** familiarity with at least one of the group's areas of operation — OSINT, digital infrastructure analysis, forensic documentation, information security, or tool development. Mastering everything isn't necessary; mastering something in depth and having a clear awareness of one's own limits is.
- **Behavioral dimension:** the ability to work under pressure without losing rigor, to handle disturbing content without normalizing what is serious, to maintain confidentiality in situations where talking would be easier, and to sustain commitment even when results take time to appear.

Both dimensions carry equal weight. A technically brilliant but behaviorally unstable researcher poses a risk to the group. An emotionally mature but technically stagnant researcher limits investigations. Misters seeks balance between the two.

## 6.3 What Sets a Misters Researcher Apart

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### What Makes a Misters Different

Many people have technical skills in digital security. What sets a Misters researcher apart is not the technical level — it's the reason they use those skills and the way they use them.

- **The motivation is protection, not recognition.** A Misters researcher doesn't seek visibility, doesn't exploit cases to gain an audience, and doesn't use investigations as a showcase. The work is anonymous by choice — and that choice needs to be genuine, not just formally followed.
- **Restraint is part of competence.** Knowing what not to do is as important as knowing what to do. A Misters researcher recognizes the legal and ethical limits of the work and respects them — not because they're required to, but because they understand why those limits exist.
- **Seriousness doesn't exclude humanity.** The work is serious. The content

is heavy. But a Misters researcher doesn't become numb to what they see — they retain the capacity to be outraged, to recognize the weight of what they're investigating, and to take care of themselves and their colleagues along the way.

- **Loyalty is to the mission, not to convenience.** A Misters researcher doesn't abandon a case when it gets hard, doesn't leak information out of frustration, and doesn't use the group as a platform for personal interests. The mission comes first.

## 6.4 What Being a Misters Researcher Is Not

### Common Misconceptions — What a Mister Is Not

The nature of Misters' work sometimes attracts profiles that misunderstand what the group represents. It's important to be explicit about what a Misters researcher is not:

- **It is not being a vigilante.** Misters does not carry out punishments, does not publicly expose those under investigation, and does not mobilize third parties against targets. Accountability is the authorities' function — the group provides evidence, not the verdict.
- **It is not being a hacktivist.** Misters does not carry out attacks, does not break into systems, and does not take down services — regardless of how reprehensible the target's conduct may be. The investigation is passive and observational.
- **It is not being "nice".** Being a Misters researcher requires firmness, the ability to make difficult decisions, and a willingness to confront situations most people would rather ignore. Kindness without substance doesn't serve the mission.
- **It is not being invulnerable.** The work is heavy and carries a real emotional cost. Pretending it doesn't affect you is as problematic as being unable to cope. A Misters researcher recognizes their limits and communicates them.
- **It is not a public identity.** Being a Mister is not a title to show off, an affiliation to mention on profiles, or a credential to gain access to other groups. It is a private commitment to a serious mission.

## 6.5 Fitness Criteria

### What Makes Someone Fit

Fitness to be a Misters researcher is assessed based on objective criteria, observed throughout the onboarding period. Someone is considered fit when they demonstrate:

1. **Consistency of conduct:** behavior aligned with Misters' values and rules over time — not just in the first few weeks.
2. **Real contribution:** active participation that adds value to investigations or the group's infrastructure, within one's own areas of expertise.
3. **Operational maturity:** the ability to follow protocols, document the work, and make responsible decisions without needing constant supervision.
4. **Emotional management:** the ability to handle disturbing content without compromising the rigor of the work or one's own and others' well-being.
5. **Reliability:** a track record of confidentiality, punctuality with commitments made, and the absence of behaviors that have created risk or conflict for the group.

### What Makes Someone Unfit

Likewise, there are behaviors and traits that make someone unfit to be part of Misters — regardless of technical level:

- Seeking public recognition or visibility associated with the group;
- A history of leaking information, even in contexts outside Misters;
- Inability to separate personal motivations from the group's mission;
- Unstable behavior under pressure or in situations of internal conflict;
- Consistent disregard for limits — legal, ethical, or operational — even after guidance;
- Using the group as a platform for personal interests, ideologies, or agendas.

Unfitness is not a judgment of character — it's a recognition of incompatibility with the kind of work Misters carries out. The group isn't for everyone, and that's not a criticism of those who don't fit.



## 7 Onboarding — Guide for New Researchers

*“Joining Misters isn’t signing a contract. It’s beginning a process — of learning, trust, and growing responsibility.”*

This chapter is addressed specifically to those who are just arriving. If you’re reading this, you’ve gone through the onboarding process and been approved to join Misters — whether by invitation from an active researcher or through recruitment via the official form. Welcome.

What follows is not a task list. It’s a map of what to expect, what’s expected of you, and how to navigate your first steps within the organization.

### How You Got Here

If you’re reading this chapter, you’ve gone through Misters’ recruitment process — either through the public form or by direct invitation from an active researcher — and you’ve been approved by Central. The process that preceded your joining is described in the Recruitment chapter. What begins now is the observation period.

### 7.1 The Observation Period

#### What It Is and Why It Exists

Every new researcher goes through an **observation period** before gaining access to active operations. This period is neither a punishment nor a sign of distrust — it’s a mutual protection.

During the observation period:

- You **do not have access** to evidence, dossiers, or ongoing cases;
- You **do have access** to the general internal communication channels, this document, and Misters’ values and rules;
- You **can and should** ask questions, observe how the group operates, and familiarize yourself with the culture and protocols;
- Your Connection’s Front is your main point of contact during this period.

The length of the observation period is set by Central and communicated at the time you join. At the end, Central evaluates whether full membership is approved

based on the conduct observed.

## 7.2 What to Read First

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### Mandatory Reading for New Researchers

Before anything else, read — in this order:

1. **Misters' Values** — understanding what drives the group matters more than understanding how it works. The values are the filter every decision passes through.
2. **Misters' Rules** — especially the Internal Conduct and OpSec and Anonymity sections. These are the rules that affect you immediately, even before you take part in any investigation.
3. **Misters' Hierarchy** — understand where you stand in the structure, who your Front is, who the Line of your Lineage is, and how communication flows within the group.
4. **Ethics and Limits of Operation** — know what Misters doesn't do before knowing what it does. The limits matter as much as the objectives.
5. **Profile of a Researcher** — honestly assess whether the profile described matches who you are today and who you're willing to become.

## 7.3 Practical First Steps

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### What to Do in the First Few Days

1. **Set up your operational environment.** Completely separate the tools and accounts you'll use for Misters from your personal accounts. This includes email, messaging apps, browsers, and operating systems where possible. See the Tools and Infrastructure chapter for reference.
2. **Set and use your pseudonym.** The pseudonym you use within Misters must have no traceable link to your real identity on any other platform. Choose it carefully — and don't reuse it in other contexts.
3. **Strip metadata from any file shared internally.** Before sending any file

in the group's channels, check and remove its metadata. This applies to images, documents, and any other file type.

4. **Introduce yourself to your Front.** Establish communication with your Connection's Front. They are your immediate point of reference for operational questions, guidance about the Lineage, and communication with higher levels of the hierarchy.
5. **Observe before acting.** The observation period exists for a reason. Use this time to understand the group's culture, not to demonstrate what you know. Hasty contributions without context do more harm than good.

## 7.4 What Not to Do

### Common Mistakes New Researchers Make

- **Sharing that you joined Misters.** Even with trusted people outside the group. Confidentiality starts on day one — not after you feel "settled in."
- **Using unapproved tools.** Technical curiosity is welcome — but not within Misters operations. Tools that haven't been vetted by the group cannot be used in any operational context.
- **Trying to speed up the observation period.** Showing enthusiasm is positive. Pushing for access to cases ahead of time is a sign that you haven't yet understood why the observation period exists.
- **Acting on your own.** No investigative action — however small — should be taken without informing the group during the observation period. And this rule doesn't change much after full membership either.
- **Underestimating the OpSec rules.** Operational security rules seem excessive until the moment they no longer do. Follow them from the start — not after making a mistake that can't be undone.

### One Last Word for Those Just Arriving

Misters isn't an easy group to join — and that's intentional. The rigor of the onboarding process and the observation period exists because the work that comes after is too serious to be carried out by people who aren't ready for it. If you made it this far, it's because someone believed you have what it takes. Now it's up to you to confirm that belief — not with words, but with consistent conduct over time.

## 8 Investigation Methodology

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*“A method is not bureaucracy — it is what turns intention into a usable result.”*

Misters’ methodology was not invented in a meeting. It was built over the course of real cases, mistakes made, and protocols refined until reaching what works. It exists to ensure that the work produced by the group has value beyond the moment it was created — that evidence is admissible, that reports are understandable by external authorities, and that no investigation depends on the memory of whoever conducted it.

This chapter details the procedures for each investigative phase, the documentation standards adopted by the group, and the differences between the modes of operation.

### 8.1 Report and Dossier — The Fundamental Difference

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### Report vs. Dossier

Misters produces two types of investigative documents, and the distinction between them is not merely formal — it defines the weight, depth, and ultimate destination of the work performed:

- **Report:** a document produced at the conclusion of individual cases or lower-complexity collective investigations. It records the established facts, the evidence collected, the methodology used, and the conclusions reached. It is objective, direct, and sufficient for referring the case to the competent authorities or platforms. It may be produced by a single researcher, subject to review by the case coordinator.
- **Dossier:** a document produced in deeper collective investigations and, mandatorily, in all Cyber Operations. It is more extensive, more structured, and more detailed than a report — including analysis of links between actors, a timeline of events, correlation of multiple evidence sources, and an impact assessment. It requires review by all researchers involved in the investigation before referral.

#### Absolute Rule

Every Cyber Operation mandatorily results in a **Dossier** — never in a simple report. The complexity and severity of an Operation demand the level of structure and traceability that only a dossier can provide. Referring a Cyber Operation with a simple report is a serious methodological failure.

## 8.2 Phase 1 — Screening

### Screening Procedures

Screening is the entry point of any investigation. Its purpose is to determine whether a case deserves to be opened — and whether Misters is currently able to conduct it properly.

#### Procedures:

1. The case is presented to the group with a description of the available indications, the source of the information, and the area of operation involved.
2. The group collectively evaluates three criteria:
  - *Sufficiency*: are there enough concrete indications to justify an investigation?
  - *Fit*: does the case fall within Misters' areas of operation?

- *Capacity*: does the group have the technical and emotional resources available to conduct the case now?
3. The decision to open or shelve the case is formally recorded, with date and justification.
  4. Cases shelved at screening may be reopened if new indications emerge.

**Minimum screening documentation:**

- Date the case was received;
- Source and nature of the initial indications;
- Decision made (opened / shelved) and justification;
- Defined mode of operation (individual case, collective investigation, or Cyber Operation).

## 8.3 Phase 2 — Collection

### Collection Procedures

Collection is the phase of greatest operational exposure — and, for that reason, the one that demands the most discipline. Any mistake made here can compromise the following phases and invalidate the entire body of work.

**Procedures:**

1. All collection is carried out with proper anonymization of the connection and in an environment isolated from the researcher's personal use.
2. Each piece of evidence collected is immediately preserved in its original form — without editing, cropping, or modification of any kind.
3. The hash (SHA-256) of each evidence file is generated and recorded at the moment of capture.
4. Web pages are captured using a tool approved by the group, preserving URL, date, time, and full content.
5. Evidence of an extremely graphic nature is accessed by the minimum number of researchers necessary and logged with controlled access.
6. All collection is documented in real time — never reconstructed afterward.

**Minimum documentation for each piece of evidence:**

- Unique evidence identifier (e.g.: EV-2026-001);

- Date and time of collection;
- URL or source of origin;
- Collection method used;
- SHA-256 hash of the file;
- Researcher responsible for the collection;
- Verification status (verified / pending verification).

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## 8.4 Phase 3 — Analysis

### Analysis Procedures

Analysis is the phase of greatest technical depth. Its purpose is to transform raw evidence into structured understanding — identifying actors, links, patterns, and the scope of what is being investigated.

**Procedures:**

1. Analysis is conducted separately from the raw evidence — in its own document, never directly on the original material.
2. Established facts and inferences are clearly distinguished. No inference is presented as fact without supporting evidence.
3. Links between actors are mapped based exclusively on collected evidence — not on assumptions or unverified external information.
4. Contradictions or gaps identified during analysis are explicitly recorded — and, when possible, the case is returned to the collection phase for further work.
5. In Cyber Operations, the analysis mandatorily includes a timeline of events and a map of links between actors.

**Minimum analysis documentation:**

- List of identified actors with references to the evidence supporting them;
- Observed behavior patterns;
- Links between actors and the structures involved;
- Identified gaps and contradictions;
- Clear distinction between established facts and inferences.

## 8.5 Phase 4 — Documentation

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### Documentation Procedures

Documentation is what makes Misters' work usable beyond the group. A well-produced dossier or report can be understood and used by an authority who did not take part in the investigation — and that is exactly the goal.

#### Minimum structure of a Report:

1. **Case identification** — code, opening date, mode of operation, and coordinator;
2. **Executive summary** — objective description of the case in up to one paragraph;
3. **Initial indications** — what prompted the opening of the investigation;
4. **Methodology** — how the investigation was conducted;
5. **Evidence** — referenced list with unique identifiers;
6. **Conclusions** — established facts and, separately, inferences;
7. **Suggested referral** — recommended channel or authority.

#### Minimum structure of a Dossier (includes everything in the report, plus):

8. **Timeline** — detailed chronology of the events investigated;
9. **Actor map** — identification of and links between all parties involved;
10. **Impact analysis** — estimated scope of the crime and number of identified victims;
11. **Evidence access log** — who accessed each piece of sensitive evidence and when;
12. **Review record** — who reviewed the document, on what date, and with what observations.



## 8.6 Phase 5 — Review

### Review Procedures

No document leaves Misters without review. Review is not a formality — it is the last line of defense against errors that could invalidate the investigation or harm victims.

#### Procedures:

1. In individual cases, the coordinator reviews the report before referral.
2. In collective investigations, at least one additional researcher besides the coordinator reviews the report or dossier.
3. In Cyber Operations, the review is carried out by all researchers involved. Unanimity is required to proceed to referral.
4. The review checks: consistency between the evidence and the conclusions, the distinction between facts and inferences, the absence of information that could identify the group's researchers, and the appropriateness of the suggested referral.
5. Review observations are recorded in the document along with the reviewer's identification and the date.
6. Documents that do not pass review return to the documentation phase for correction.

## 8.7 Phase 6 — Referral

### Referral Procedures

Referral is the moment when Misters' work connects with the system that has the authority to act. It must be planned with the same care as all the previous phases.

#### Procedures:

1. The referral channel is defined based on the type of crime, the jurisdiction involved, and the urgency of the case:
  - *Digital platforms*: for illegal content hosted on online services;
  - *Specialized police units*: for crimes with identifiable authorship in Brazil;
  - *Public Prosecutor's Office*: for cases of greater severity or systemic impact;

- *International bodies*: for cases with actors or victims across multiple jurisdictions.
- 2. Referral is carried out exclusively by the case coordinator or by a formally designated researcher.
- 3. In Cyber Operations, the timing of the referral is deliberated collectively — taking into account the risk of alerting the targets before the authorities can act.
- 4. Every referral is logged internally with date, channel used, method of submission, and receipt protocol when available.
- 5. Referral does not end the group's responsibility — following up on the report is part of the process.

## 8.8 Phase 7 — Closure and Archiving

### Closure Procedures

Every case has a formal closure — whether after referral, due to suspension, or due to an inability to make further progress. Closure is not the end of the record: it is the beginning of the archive.

#### **Procedures:**

1. The coordinator formally records the closure of the case with date, reason, and final status (referred, suspended, or shelved without referral).
2. Evidence is archived in an encrypted, access-restricted repository, or destroyed according to internal protocol — especially in the case of child abuse material.
3. The final report or dossier is archived in the group's internal history for future reference.
4. Cases closed without referral are recorded with a justification — and may only be reopened upon presentation of a new element that justifies the decision.
5. In Cyber Operations, closure mandatorily includes an internal debriefing — a review of what worked, what failed, and what should be incorporated into the group's protocols.

## 9 Crisis Protocol

*“A poorly managed crisis causes more damage than the crisis itself.”*

Misters’ work involves real risks — to the researchers, to ongoing investigations, and to the integrity of the group. This chapter defines what constitutes a crisis, who may declare one, the principles guiding any response, and the specific protocols for each type of critical situation.

### 9.1 What Constitutes a Crisis

#### Definition and Crisis Levels

- **Level 1 — Contained Crisis:** affects one researcher or one specific investigation, with no immediate risk of spreading.
- **Level 2 — Systemic Crisis:** threatens the group as a whole — operational security, the identity of multiple researchers, or the integrity of several investigations simultaneously.

### 9.2 Who May Declare a State of Crisis

#### Crisis Declaration

- **Any researcher** can and must immediately report to the group any event they consider a threat.
- **Level 1 Crisis** may be declared by the coordinator of the affected case or by any member of the administration.
- **Level 2 Crisis** requires confirmation from at least two members of the administration.
- **No crisis should be ignored** by whoever receives the report, regardless of who reported it.

## 9.3 General Response Principles

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### How Misters Responds to Crises

- **Containment before analysis:** the first action is to limit the immediate damage.
- **Immediate internal communication:** all relevant researchers must be informed quickly.
- **Absolute external silence:** no information is disclosed externally without deliberation — except in cases of imminent physical risk.
- **Collective decisions, rapid execution:** crises demand speed, but do not authorize unilateral action.
- **Record everything:** every action taken during a crisis must be logged.
- **Mandatory post-crisis review:** every closed crisis goes through an internal debriefing.

## 9.4 Specific Protocols

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### Researcher Identity Compromised

1. The affected researcher immediately notifies the group with as much detail as is available.
2. The group declares a Level 1 or Level 2 Crisis depending on the extent of the compromise.
3. The affected researcher immediately suspends all operational activity.
4. All of the researcher's access is temporarily suspended as a preventive measure.
5. The group assesses whether other researchers were potentially exposed through the same vector.
6. If there is a genuine physical risk, contacting the authorities is authorized and encouraged.
7. After containment, the group deliberates on the researcher's return to activities.

### **Investigation Leaked Externally**

1. The affected investigation is immediately suspended.
2. The group identifies the perimeter of the leak: what was exposed, to whom, and through which channel.
3. An internal audit is conducted to identify the source.
4. If intentional leaking is suspected, the suspected researcher's access is preventively suspended.
5. The impact on subjects under investigation, victims, and authorities is assessed.
6. The case is resumed, suspended, or closed according to a collective decision.

### **Researcher in Physical Danger**

1. A researcher in danger has full authority to contact the authorities immediately — physical safety overrides any protocol.
2. The group is notified as soon as possible, but this notification must never delay the search for safety.
3. All investigations related to the identified risk are suspended.
4. The researcher's return to activities is decided by the researcher themselves, without pressure from the group.

### **Hostile Contact from a Subject Under Investigation**

1. The researcher does not respond to the contact under any circumstances.
2. The contact is fully documented and reported to the group immediately.
3. The group assesses whether the contact indicates an identity compromise or a speculative intimidation attempt.
4. If the contact includes concrete threats, the researcher-in-physical-danger protocol is activated in parallel.
5. The material from the hostile contact is preserved as evidence.

### **Critical Infrastructure Failure**

1. The researcher who identifies the failure notifies the group through the contingency channel.
2. All activity dependent on the affected infrastructure is suspended.

3. The group determines whether the failure is technical or whether there are signs of external compromise.
4. If compromise is suspected, all access is preventively revoked.
5. Restoration is performed only by researchers with the relevant technical competence, with each step logged.

#### Contentious Researcher Departure

1. All of the researcher's access is revoked immediately.
2. The group audits everything the researcher had access to.
3. Shared credentials are rotated immediately.
4. Investigations to which the researcher had access are assessed for risk of compromise.
5. The group monitors external channels for a set period.
6. If a leak is confirmed, the leaked-investigation protocol is activated in parallel.

## 9.5 Post-Crisis

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#### Debriefing and Protocol Updates

Every debriefing must answer four questions:

1. **What happened?** A factual, chronological reconstruction.
2. **How did the group respond?** An assessment of speed, coordination, and effectiveness.
3. **What could have prevented the crisis?** Identification of process or conduct failures.
4. **What changes from now on?** Concrete actions with a defined owner and deadline.

A crisis from which the group learns nothing is a crisis that will repeat itself.

## 10 Misters Against the Evils of the Internet

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*“Technical knowledge without purpose is an idle tool. With purpose, it is a form of protection.”*

The internet is simultaneously the most democratic and the most dangerous environment humanity has ever built. Within it, communities, knowledge, and connection coexist — but so do predators, criminal networks, and forms of violence that exploit the very openness and anonymity that make the network so valuable.

Misters has chosen to occupy this space with technical purpose and ethical responsibility. This chapter defines how the group confronts cybercrime, how it supports those who have been victimized, and how it maintains the balance between acting and overstepping.

### 10.1 How Misters Confronts Cybercrime

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### Technical and Methodological Approach

Misters' work against cybercrime is neither reactive nor improvised. It is structured, planned, and conducted within the limits that make the work legitimate:

- **Active monitoring:** researchers track digital environments where serious crimes are planned, coordinated, or shared — identifying patterns, actors, and structures before the harm materializes or spreads.
- **Evidence collection and preservation:** all relevant information is collected with methodological rigor, preserved in its original form, and documented in a way that maintains its validity for use by the competent authorities.
- **Infrastructure analysis:** Misters investigates not only the criminal acts themselves, but the structures that sustain them — profiles, networks, funders, facilitators, and platforms used — so that referral can be as complete as possible.
- **Strategic referral:** the evidence produced is referred to the appropriate channels — authorities, platforms, or international bodies — with the timing and format that maximize the chance of effective action.
- **Tool development:** when available solutions are insufficient, the group develops its own tools — adapted to the real needs of the investigations and internally auditable.

## 10.2 Supporting Those Who Have Been Victimized

### Victim Support

Misters' technical work does not exist in a vacuum — it exists because real people are being harmed. Recognizing this is part of the mission.

When an investigation involves identifiable victims, Misters adopts the following principles:

- **Dignity first.** No evidence, account, or image involving victims is treated as neutral technical data. They are people — and deserve to be treated as such at every stage of the process.
- **Identity protection.** Information that could identify victims is shared only with those who strictly need it to conduct the investigation or referral. Never externally without authorization.
- **No retraumatization.** Misters' work must not add harm to harm already suffered. This means avoiding unnecessary exposure, not circulating disturbing material beyond what is strictly necessary, and not using real cases as



public illustration.

- **Sensitive referral.** Whenever possible and appropriate, referral to the authorities takes the impact on the victim into account — ensuring that the legal process does not become yet another source of suffering.

### 10.3 The Limits of the Group's Work

#### What Misters Does Not Do — Even When It Wants To

There are situations where the urge to act is real — but acting the wrong way would be worse than not acting at all. Misters recognizes these limits and respects them:

- **Does not act on emotional impulse.** Serious cases provoke legitimate anger. But anger is not a methodology — and decisions made on impulse rarely produce usable results. Emotional discipline is part of the work.
- **Does not expose subjects under investigation before referral.** Even when the evidence seems conclusive, Misters does not disclose identities, does not publish dossiers, and does not mobilize third parties against targets. Accountability is the function of the authorities — not of the group.
- **Does not act beyond its capacity.** Recognizing when a case is beyond the group's technical, emotional, or operational capabilities is a form of responsibility — not weakness. A poorly handled case can destroy evidence and alert criminals.
- **Does not replace the authorities.** Misters complements the formal system — it does not replace it. When authorities are already acting on a case, the group assesses whether its involvement adds value or creates interference.

#### What Sustains This Work

Confronting the worst of the internet — crimes against children, the planning of massacres, organized cruelty, systematic hatred — carries a real cost. Not only technical, but human.

What sustains this work is not the absence of emotional impact. It is clarity of purpose, support among researchers, and the certainty that every investigation conducted with rigor represents a real chance that something will change — for a victim, for a family, for a community.

Misters does not fight the evils of the internet because it believes it will eliminate

them. It fights because it believes that doing nothing, when one has the knowledge and the capacity to act, is a choice — and a choice this group refuses to make.

## 11 Tools and Infrastructure

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*“An investigation is only as reliable as the infrastructure that supports it.”*

Misters’ infrastructure is built on three complementary pillars: open-source tools, commercial solutions evaluated and approved by the group, and proprietary tools developed in-house when no existing option meets the operational needs with the required level of control and security.

### 11.1 Adoption Criteria

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#### What Every Tool Must Meet

- **Auditability:** the group must be able to understand what the tool does and what data it handles.
- **Minimal exposure:** the tool must not collect or transmit data beyond what is strictly necessary.
- **Isolation:** operational tools must run isolated from researchers’ personal environments.
- **Maintainability:** every solution must be understandable by more than one researcher.
- **Proportionality:** the complexity of a solution must be proportional to the problem it solves.

### 11.2 Open Source and Commercial Tools

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#### Use of External Tools

Misters uses external tools whenever an existing solution solves the problem with adequate security, maturity, and justifiable cost. Approved external tools cover the following categories:

- **Collection and OSINT:** profile tracking, identity correlation, digital infras-

tructure analysis, and recovery of removed content.

- **Anonymity and OpSec:** connection anonymization, metadata removal, and isolated execution environments.
- **Storage and Evidence:** forensic capture, hash-based integrity verification, and encrypted storage.
- **Internal Communication:** end-to-end encrypted channels, with preference given to self-hosted or decentralized solutions.

The full list of approved external tools is maintained in an internal repository and reviewed periodically.

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## 11.3 In-House Development

### Misters' Proprietary Solutions

When no external tool meets the operational needs with the necessary level of control, the group develops its own solutions. In-house development follows these guidelines:

- All code is documented and versioned in a repository with access restricted to active researchers;
- No internal solution is made public without a collective decision;
- Critical tools must be understandable by at least two researchers;
- Development must be proposed and approved before it begins.

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## 11.4 How the Three Approaches Complement Each Other

### Open Source, Commercial, and In-House — In Practice

1. **Is there a mature, auditable open-source solution?** If so, it is evaluated first.
2. **Does the open-source solution have critical gaps that a commercial tool would resolve?** If so, the cost is assessed and submitted to the

group's fund.

3. **Does no external option meet the necessary level of control?** In-house development is then proposed and deliberated.

#### Unauthorized Use of Tools

It is prohibited to use any tool — external or internal — in Misters' operations that has not been formally evaluated and approved by the group. Researchers who identify relevant new tools must propose them to the group for evaluation before any operational use.

## 12 Misters Investment Fund

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*“Tools don’t do the work — but without them, the work doesn’t happen.”*

Misters is a volunteer, non-profit initiative. No researcher is paid, no service is charged for, and no investigation has financial value. However, technical work depends on tools, services, and infrastructure that carry a real cost.

The Misters Investment Fund exists to cover these costs collectively, voluntarily, and transparently, without creating financial obligations for any researcher.

### 12.1 Fund Principles

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#### How the Fund Works

- **Contribution is strictly voluntary.** No researcher is required or pressured to contribute financially. Participation in the group does not depend on contributing to the fund.
- **Any amount is valid.** The fund has no minimum contribution amount.
- **Contributions do not grant additional rights.** Contributing financially does not confer greater decision-making power or privileged access to cases.
- **The fund is not a source of income.** It is expressly prohibited to use fund resources to pay researchers or cover personal expenses.

### 12.2 Fund Management

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#### Management Responsibility

Management of the fund is centralized in a researcher designated by **Central** — the **Fund Manager**. The position is assigned by the Leader with the Master’s approval, and may be revoked by Central at any time upon recorded justification. The Manager is responsible for:

- Receiving and recording contributions made;
- Carrying out purchases and contracts approved by the group;
- Maintaining an internal record of income and expenses accessible to Central;
- Reporting the available balance whenever a new acquisition is being deliberated;
- Reporting to Central whenever requested.

The Manager has no autonomy to make expenditures that have not been collectively deliberated. Every acquisition — regardless of amount — requires prior approval from Central. In the event of suspected misuse of the fund, Central may immediately suspend the Manager and initiate an internal audit.

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## 12.3 What May Be Purchased

### Permitted Uses of the Fund

- VPN services and connection anonymization for operational use;
- OSINT tools, data analysis, and digital tracking tools;
- Secure, encrypted storage infrastructure;
- Internal communication platforms with end-to-end encryption;
- Domains, servers, or hosting services used in operations;
- Software licenses needed to conduct investigations;
- Data verification services for specific investigations.

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## 12.4 What May Not Be Purchased

### Prohibited Uses of the Fund

- Payment or any form of compensation to researchers;
- Personal expenses of any researcher;
- Tools intended for offensive actions or illegal activities;

- Donations or transfers to third parties or external organizations;
- Expenditures not collectively deliberated;
- Any acquisition with no direct relation to Misters' operations.

#### **Final Note on the Fund**

The Misters Investment Fund is an operational instrument — not an obligation, nor a measure of commitment. Researchers who contribute and researchers who do not contribute hold exactly the same standing within the group. What sustains Misters is not money — it is the work of those who believe in the mission.



## 13 Emotional Balance and Mental Health

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*“No researcher is a machine. And pretending to be one protects no one — not the investigation, not the researcher.”*

Misters’ work exposes its researchers to content most people will never see — and shouldn’t have to see. Images of abuse, planning of violence, networks of organized cruelty. This comes at a cost. An emotional cost, a psychological cost, and, if ignored, an operational cost.

This chapter is not optional. It is not a corporate wellness appendix. It is part of the methodology — because an emotionally exhausted researcher is a researcher who makes mistakes, who leaks information, who makes impulsive decisions, or who simply stops functioning. Taking care of mental health is not weakness. It is operational intelligence.

### 13.1 What the Work Can Cause

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### Real Impacts of Investigative Work

Security researchers who repeatedly deal with disturbing content are subject to a range of impacts that need to be acknowledged — not ignored:

- **Compassion fatigue:** prolonged exposure to others' suffering can lead to a state of emotional exhaustion in which the capacity to feel empathy diminishes — or in which the emotional weight becomes unbearable. Neither extreme is healthy.
- **Vicarious trauma:** repeatedly absorbing content from serious crimes can produce symptoms similar to those experienced by someone who lived through the trauma directly — nightmares, flashbacks, hypervigilance, difficulty disconnecting.
- **Progressive desensitization:** the opposite is also a risk. When severe content starts to feel routine, the researcher can lose the ability to perceive the weight of what they are seeing — and this compromises both ethical rigor and operational judgment.
- **Isolation:** the secretive nature of the work makes it difficult to talk about it outside the group. This can create a sense of isolation that, over time, weighs significantly on mental health.

## 13.2 Researchers' Rights and Protections

### What Every Researcher Is Entitled To

Misters formally recognizes the following rights for all of its researchers with regard to mental health and emotional balance:

- **The right to decline cases.** Any researcher may decline to take part in an investigation for emotional reasons, without needing to provide a detailed justification and without any consequence to their standing within the group. Declining is not weakness — it is self-awareness.
- **The right to take temporary leave.** A researcher who recognizes they are going through a difficult time may notify their Front, Line, or Central directly and step away from activities for as long as needed — without losing their place in the group, provided the situation is communicated.
- **The right not to access extreme content.** Not every researcher needs to see everything. The principle of minimum necessary access exists both for operational security and for emotional protection. No one should be exposed to disturbing material beyond what their role requires.

- **The right to be heard.** Researchers going through work-related emotional difficulties have the right to communicate this to the group without judgment. The group has the responsibility to listen — and to act to reduce the impact whenever possible.

### 13.3 The Group's Responsibilities

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#### What Misters Commits to Doing

Caring for researchers' mental health is not the exclusive responsibility of each individual. It is also the responsibility of the group as a whole — especially of those in leadership positions:

- **Not pressuring researchers to take part in cases that affect them.** This applies at every level of the hierarchy. Neither the Master, nor the Leader, nor the Line may pressure a researcher to remain on an investigation that is causing emotional harm.
- **Distributing the weight of heavy cases.** Investigations involving extreme content should not repeatedly fall on the same researchers. Conscious rotation in these situations is a management responsibility — not a suggestion.
- **Creating space for the impact to be named.** The group must have internal channels where researchers can communicate emotional difficulties without it affecting their reputation or standing. Forced silence is just as harmful as the content itself.
- **Recognizing signs of overload.** Lineage and Connection Leaders must stay attentive to changes in behavior, drops in engagement, or signs of exhaustion in the researchers under their responsibility — and act preventively, not only reactively.

## 13.4 The Wounds This Work Leaves

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### About What Goes Unspoken — But Needs to Be Said

There is a kind of wound that investigative work leaves, one that is rarely named: that of carrying the knowledge of things that shouldn't exist. Seeing the worst in people. Documenting real suffering. Knowing that, even after every effort, justice will not always follow.

This weighs on you. And pretending it doesn't is where the problem begins.

Misters has no way to eliminate this weight — it is inherent to the mission. But it can do two things: acknowledge it openly, as this chapter does, and build a culture where carrying that weight together is easier than carrying it alone.

Researchers who feel they are reaching their limit should seek outside professional support. Misters actively encourages this — not as a sign of incapacity, but as a sign of responsibility toward oneself. A researcher who takes care of themselves takes better care of the work. And takes better care of the victims this work exists to protect.

## 14 Internal Frequently Asked Questions

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*“An unanswered question becomes an assumption. And assumptions within a security group are dangerous.”*

This chapter gathers the most common questions within Misters — especially among new researchers or those in an observation period. The answers here do not replace the group’s collective judgment in specific situations, but serve as a quick reference for the most recurring questions.

### 14.1 About Joining and Structure

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#### Questions About How the Group Works

##### **Can I refer someone to Misters?**

Yes — as long as you are an active researcher and fully trust the person you are referring. Remember: you are jointly responsible for the conduct of the referred person during their observation period.

##### **How long does the observation period last?**

The duration is set by Central and communicated at the time of joining. There is no fixed universal timeframe — it depends on the evaluation of observed conduct and Central’s availability to carry out the formal assessment.

##### **Can I change Connection or Lineage?**

Yes, but not unilaterally. The change must be communicated to the Front of your current Connection and approved by the Line of the relevant Lineage. Transfers between different Lineages require Central’s approval.

##### **What happens if the Operator responsible for my Lineage leaves the group?**

The Lineage is not automatically dissolved. Central appoints a new Operator or temporarily takes over management while a replacement is identified and approved.

##### **Can I hold positions in more than one Connection at the same time?**

No. Each researcher belongs to one active Connection at a time. Participation in multiple Connections simultaneously is not permitted — it undermines commitment to each one and creates compartmentalization risks.

## 14.2 About Investigations and Cases

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### Questions About Investigative Work

#### **Can I suggest a case for investigation?**

Yes. Any active researcher may bring a case to the group. Formal opening, however, depends on collective approval following screening. Presenting a case does not guarantee that it will be opened.

#### **What do I do if I come across disturbing content during personal research outside of Misters?**

Document the minimum necessary to identify the source and report it to the group. Do not attempt to investigate on your own — and do not share the content outside Misters' internal channels.

#### **Can I take part in an investigation if I'm emotionally affected by the subject matter?**

It is not recommended — and you have the right to decline without needing a detailed justification. Notify the case coordinator or your Front and step back. Your emotional health takes priority over any investigation.

#### **What is a Dossier and when is it required?**

A Dossier is the most complete investigative document produced by Misters — it includes a timeline, an actor map, an impact analysis, and an access history. It is mandatory in all Cyber Operations and recommended in more complex collective investigations. Simple individual cases may result in a Report instead.

#### **Can I contact a victim during an investigation?**

No — not without explicit consensus from the group. Unauthorized contact with victims can compromise the investigation, retraumatize the person, and expose the researcher. Any necessary contact must be planned collectively and carried out by the case coordinator.

## 14.3 About OpSec and Security

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### Questions About Operational Security

#### **Do I need to use a VPN for everything I do within Misters?**

For any operational activity — yes. For reading internal documents in a secure, private environment — assess the risk. The general rule is: when in doubt, use a VPN.

#### **What do I do if I suspect my identity has been compromised?**

Report it immediately to the group through secure channels. Suspend all operational activity until the group assesses the situation. Do not try to handle it alone — follow the crisis protocol described in the corresponding chapter.

**Can I mention Misters in conversations with friends or family?**

No. Secrecy about the group's existence and activities is permanent and has no exceptions — regardless of how much you trust the person.

**Someone outside the group contacted me mentioning Misters. What do I do?**

Do not respond. Document the contact — including channel, date, time, and content — and report it to the group immediately. Follow the hostile contact protocol described in the crisis chapter.

**Can I use my personal device for Misters activities?**

In situations of necessity, yes — but with maximum isolation: a dedicated browser, an active VPN, and no overlap with personal accounts. A separate device for operational activities is always the ideal.

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## 14.4 About Leaving and Departure

### Questions About Leaving the Group

**Can I leave Misters whenever I want?**

Yes. Any researcher has the right to withdraw at any time, with no justification required. The departure must be formally communicated to the Front or the Line.

**What happens to my access when I leave?**

It is revoked immediately by the Operator responsible for the Lineage, with confirmation from Central. Shared credentials are rotated.

**Can I return to the group after a voluntary departure?**

It depends on the circumstances of the departure and Central's assessment. Voluntary departures that were properly communicated can be reversed. Dismissals for rule violations are permanent and do not allow re-entry.

**Do my confidentiality obligations end when I leave?**

No. Confidentiality obligations are permanent — regardless of the reason for leaving or how long you were part of the group. This includes information about investigations, researchers, methods, and infrastructure.

## 15 Recruitment

*“Misters does not seek the most experienced — it seeks the most committed. Experience is built. Commitment either exists or it doesn’t.”*

Recruitment is the first point of contact between Misters and anyone who wishes to join the group. It is a rigorous process — not because the group is elitist, but because the work carried out here demands real responsibility. This chapter defines how recruitment works, who can recruit, what is evaluated, and the path followed from initial interest to formal admission.

### 15.1 Who May Recruit

#### Recruiters Within Misters

Recruitment may be initiated by any active Misters researcher — regardless of their hierarchical level. This includes:

- **Any active researcher:** may refer a trusted person directly to the Front of their Connection or to the Line of their Lineage.
- **Connection Front:** may actively recruit for their Connection, evaluating candidates who arrive via the form or by referral.
- **Lineage Line:** oversees the recruitment process within their Lineage and approves or rejects candidates before forwarding them to Central.
- **Central Operator:** has the authority to recruit directly and may intervene in the process when necessary.

#### Universal Admission Rule

Regardless of who recruited the candidate or through which channel they arrived — **every new member mandatorily starts in a Connection.** There is no direct admission into a Lineage or Central. Hierarchical progression is always sequential.



## 15.2 Recruitment Channels

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### How Someone Can Join Misters

There are two official recruitment channels:

- **Public form:** made available by Misters through channels controlled by the organization. Any interested person may fill it out and await evaluation. The form is the main channel for those who have no direct contact with an active researcher.
- **Direct invitation:** an active researcher identifies someone with a suitable profile and formally invites them to join. The researcher who extends the invitation is jointly responsible for the conduct of the referred person throughout the entire observation period.

No other channel is valid. Informal approaches outside the official channels — on social media, forums, or any external environment — do not constitute legitimate recruitment and must not be treated as such.

## 15.3 Minimum Requirements

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### What Every Candidate Must Have

Misters does not require prior technical experience for admission — there is an internal training process for that. But there are non-negotiable minimum requirements:

- **Minimum age:** 17 years of age — provided the candidate turns 18 within the same calendar year as their admission. The Brazilian age of majority (18 years) is the baseline criterion. Candidates who do not meet this criterion are not accepted, regardless of any other qualification.
- **Genuine availability:** full-time dedication is not required, but consistent commitment is. Candidates who cannot guarantee a minimum regular presence should not join.
- **Willingness to learn:** Misters provides internal training. What is required is not prior knowledge — it is genuine openness to learning and applying what is taught.

## 15.4 The Recruitment Process

### Process Steps

Recruitment follows a sequential flow of steps. None may be skipped:

1. **Candidate arrival:** the candidate fills out the public form or is referred by an active researcher. At this stage, no sensitive information about Misters is shared with the candidate.
2. **Profile evaluation:** before any direct contact, the Connection Front or the Lineage Line evaluates the candidate's profile based on the available information — form responses, history on public platforms, and, when applicable, the assessment of whoever referred them. The goal is to identify obvious incompatibilities before moving forward.
3. **Internal interview:** candidates who pass the profile evaluation are invited to a conversation with the Front or the Line. This is not a technical interview — it is a conversation to assess alignment with Misters' values, genuine motivation, and maturity for the type of work performed. Questions about technical experience are secondary at this stage.
4. **Central approval:** the Front or Line forwards their evaluation to the Operator responsible for the Lineage, who consults the Leader. Final approval rests with Central. Without Central's approval, admission does not take place.
5. **Admission and observation period:** an approved candidate is formally integrated into a Connection and begins the observation period. From this point on, the process follows the Onboarding chapter.

## 15.5 What Is Evaluated

### Profile Evaluation Criteria

The profile evaluation seeks to identify, before the interview, whether the candidate shows clear signs of incompatibility with Misters' mission. The main criteria observed are:

- **Stated motivation:** why does the person want to join? Motivations centered on recognition, power, or superficial curiosity are warning signs. Motivations centered on contribution and protection are positive.
- **Public history:** behavior on social media, forums, and public platforms. A

history of conflicts, irresponsible exposure of information, or hostile behavior are grounds for exclusion.

- **Consistency:** is the information provided in the form or by the referral consistent across sources? Inconsistencies need to be clarified before moving forward.
- **Meeting minimum requirements:** age, equipment, and availability are verified at this stage.

## 15.6 Rejection and Reconsideration

### When a Candidate Is Not Approved

The rejection of a candidate does not need to be publicly justified. The group does not owe the candidate a detailed explanation — only the communication that admission will not be possible at this time.

- Candidates rejected at the profile evaluation stage may try again after a minimum period set by Central — provided the reasons for rejection are correctable.
- Candidates rejected due to incompatible values or a problematic history are not reconsidered.
- The rejection decision rests with Central and cannot be overturned by the researcher who referred the candidate.

### A Note for Recruiters

Recruiting someone for Misters is an act of responsibility — not generosity. When you refer someone, you are putting your reputation within the group on the line. This should not discourage recruitment, but it should make it rigorous. The right question is not *“would this person be good for Misters?”* — it is *“would I vouch for this person’s conduct during the observation period?”* If the answer is uncertain, recruitment should wait.

## 16 Final Remarks

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*“This document is not the destination. It is the most honest starting point we were able to build.”*

You have reached the end of this document. But what is here is not a conclusion — it is a foundation. Everything written on these pages represents Misters’ current best understanding of what it is, what it does, how it does it, and why it does it. That understanding will evolve. And this document must evolve along with it.

### 16.1 About This Document

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#### How This Document Should Be Treated

This is a living document — not a sacred text. It must be reviewed, questioned, and updated whenever:

- Misters’ structure changes significantly;
- New protocols are established or existing protocols are revised;
- Real situations reveal gaps or contradictions that need to be corrected;
- The group, by consensus, recognizes that something written here no longer reflects the organization’s reality or values.

Updates must be formally proposed, deliberated by Central, and recorded with a date and version. No update is made unilaterally — not even by the Master.

### 16.2 What This Document Does Not Replace

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#### The Limits of What Is Written

However complete this document tries to be, there are things it does not replace and never will:

- **Human judgment.** Protocols cover anticipated situations. What separates a good researcher from an excellent one is the ability to act wisely in

situations no protocol could have foreseen.

- **Trust built over time.** No written rule replaces real trust between researchers — and trust is only built through consistency, time, and presence.
- **Individual conscience.** In the end, each researcher acts from who they are — not just from what they were instructed to do. The values described here only have value if they are internalized, not merely formally complied with.
- **Adaptation to the unforeseen.** The digital environment changes. Crimes evolve. Criminals adapt. Misters needs to do the same — and no document can anticipate everything that is to come.

## 16.3 A Word About What Has Been Built

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### What Reaching This Point Represents

Misters began as a small group on WhatsApp, in 2020, with a simple goal and a symbol — the red flower. It dissolved. It started over. It dissolved again. It started over with more clarity. It took four years to reach what this document represents: an organization with a consolidated identity, a defined methodology, a functional hierarchy, and values that are not mere statements — they are standards of conduct.

That is no small thing. Most groups that start the way Misters started never make it here. Not for lack of good intentions — but for lack of discipline, patience, and willingness to rebuild what didn't work.

The fact that this document exists is evidence that something different happened.

## 16.4 What Comes Next

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### Beyond This Document

Misters' next chapter is not written here. It is being built right now — in every investigation conducted with rigor, in every decision made with ethics, in every researcher who joins and finds a group worthy of the commitment it demands. This document is the map. The territory is the real work — imperfect, difficult, necessary.

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*“Behind every petal, a poison you never saw coming.”*

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Misters — Independent Security Research  
2026 Edition

— *MrWest, Founder*